

1) Write down the Evolution of Islamic Historiography mentioning the popular Classic Muslim Historians briefly.

- Islamic historiography, or the writing of Islamic history, has undergone a significant evolution since the early days of Islam. Over the centuries, various Muslim historians have contributed to the development of this field, each adding their own perspectives and interpretations of events. The nation of pride among Pre-Islamic tribes exhibited in their description through the vehicle of poetry was operative even among the Umayyads. One of them, **Abid bin shariyya**, were summoned by **Muawiyah** the founder of the Umayyad Caliphate, to relate the history of the **Kings of Yaman**. Abid bin shariyya composed a book of kings and of past history which was very much in demand in the **first century of Islam**. This early period of Islamic historiography was characterized by a focus on oral traditions and the collection and preservation of Hadith (prophetic sayings) and Sirah (biographies of the Prophet Muhammad). Some of the most famous early Muslim historians include **Abdullah ibn al-Zubayr**, **Urwah ibn al-Zubayr**, and **Aisha bint Abu Bakr**. During the classical period, Islamic historiography saw a growth in writing more structured and comprehensive histories, often with a political or ideological agenda. Some of the most prominent classic Muslim historians from this period include:

1. Ibn Ishaq: Muhammad Ibn Ishaq is the most famous writer on **Maghazi** as well as on **sira** and he is regarded as the highest authority, only to be matched by al-waqidi. But in veracity and trustworthiness, he even excels Waqidi. He had seen **Anas bin Malek** one of the companions of the Prophet and had been a great favourite of his teacher **Imam Zuhri**.

2. Ibn Hisham: Abdul Malek bin Hisham was **born in Basra and died in Egypt**. According to **Khuda Bakhsh**, in the handling of his materials Ibn Hisham shows a distinct advance upon Ibn Ishaq. He reveals greater critical insight, shows an inclination to test the sources from which the information comes and expresses his opinion on their authenticity or otherwise.

3. Ibn Sad: Ibn sad who was **secretary of al - Waqidi**, wrote a biography on prophet Muhammad. Ibn Sad's **Tabaqat-i-Kabir**, **Tabaqat-i-saghir** and **Tarikh-I-Islam** are regarded as more reliable and authentic than the works of his master al-Waqidi. Ibn Sad, the writer of another work **Tahdhib at-Tahdhib** is also praised for his comprehensive and elaborate work on the lives of the prophet and his companions.

4. Al Waqidi: Al-Waqidi wrote two works, **Kitab al-Sirah** and **Kitab al-Tarikh**. According to **Imam Shafei**, Waqidi is thoroughly unreliable; since he depended upon Jewish sources of information while writing his work. According to **Khuda Bakhsh**, stupendous was his literary and historical output in the history or the companions of the Prophet, Khuda Bakhsh says "he shows a notable advance upon his criticism of his works forerunners in the handling of his materials"

5. Ibn Qutaiba: Ibn Qutaiba wrote **Kitab al-Maarif**. The book begins with the **creation** and the author cites Biblical passages referring to it and the **creation of man and his fall**, Then follows the history of the **patriarchs** according to biblical and Arab legends. This shows that the old traditional view is, discarded and replaced by a wide intellectual vision. **The history of the Prophet forms now only a part of the whole work and non Muslim nations claim attention.**

6. Al-Tabari: With Tabari and Masudi the golden age of Muslim historiography was ushered in. His exhaustive commentary on the **Quran** and his **chronology of Apostles and Kings**, entitled **Kitab al Muluk-wa-Rasul**, brought down to **298 A.H**. Tabari acquired eminence in Tradition, Law, reading of the Quran and history. According to **Margoliouth**, **Tabari is the first great Muslim historian who dealt**

with the subject in the comprehensive and annalistic method and formed a chronological sense of events.

7. Al-Masudi: After Tabari the most important figure in historiography is Masudi. His history, a most extensive work *Kitab Akhbar-uz-Zama*, written in 30 volumes with a supplement of *Kitab-al-Awsat*, a chronological sketch of general history. It embraces social and literary history and discussions as well as geographic descriptions. Unlike Tabari's history, Masudi has arranged events around **dynasties and empires**. He did not follow the path of Tabari but created his own style of history. 'H.E. Barnes says that Masudi possessed the same avid curiosity and zeal for information as did the father of history Herodotus & as such has been called the Muslim Herodotus.

8. Ibn Khaldun: Ibn Khaldun, De Boer observes, "comes forward with a claim to establish new philosophical discipline, of which Aristotle had no conception". The historical works of his forerunners, particularly of Tabari and Masudi, have had most influence on the development of his thoughts. Masudi's new style and technique of history writing which took cognizance of society and social aspects of human life was fully developed by Ibn Khaldun and he made a scientific analytic study of history, which established history as a science subject, which teaches us that it is not a mere catalogue of facts, nor a mere narrative of past happenings, but a science to be studied for understanding the causes of the rise and fall of States and nations. **It is Ibn Khaldun's Maqaddima (prolegomena) which forms his social and political philosophy.**

2) In order to Maintain Friendly Relation with the Jews, what did the Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) do?

-The Jews of Madinah were on a different footing. They joined with the Madinah in a welcome to Muhammad (Sm). The Prophet, at the beginning, acknowledged the divine authority of their religion, and had even rested his claim upon the evidence of their Scriptures. As monotheists and as Prophet called them **"People of the book"**, Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) sought to create strong alliances with the Jews. A sub-portion of Jews even accepted him as the awaited one or the Messiah, but was rejected by overall majority. To create a friendly relation with the Jewish people, Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) took significant steps, that remain testament to his leadership qualities and worthy statesman. They include:

1. Protecting their rights: The Prophet established a treaty with the Jews in Medina known as the Constitution of Medina, which guaranteed their rights and protection as a religious minority.

2. Encouraging mutual respect: The Prophet encouraged mutual respect and cooperation between Jews and Muslims and encouraged both communities to live together in peace.

3. Avoiding conflict: The Prophet sought to avoid conflict with the Jews and, when conflicts did arise, he made efforts to resolve them peacefully.

4. Allowing religious freedom: The Prophet allowed Jews to practice their religion freely and did not interfere with their religious practices.

5. Promoting economic cooperation: The Prophet encouraged economic cooperation between Jews and Muslims, allowing both communities to prosper and thrive.

Also, the prophet adopted some of their religious practices for a brief period of time. One of them was facing the Qibla. Before the verse "The block-headed will say: "What has turned them away from the direction they formerly observed in Prayer? Say: "To Allah belong the East and the West; He guides whomsoever He wills onto a Straight Way.", **Muslims faced the qibla at Jerusalem, a custom**

practiced in Jewish communities. But after these revelations, the qibla changed toward Kaba. Prophet Muhammad(PBUH) honoured the other prophets before him mentioned in the Jewish book, because they were also part of Islam, such as Abraham, Ishaq, Joseph, Ishmael, Moses etc.

These are just a few examples of the ways in which the Prophet Muhammad sought to maintain friendly relations with the Jews. Throughout his life, he emphasized the importance of respecting and protecting the rights of religious minorities and promoting mutual respect and understanding between different communities.

3)Draw the Significance of Hdaybiah Treaty as a great victory of Islam according to the Muslim Historians 'zuhri' and 'Ibn Hisham's observations.

--The Treaty of Hdaybiyyah was an event that took place during the time of the Islamic prophet Muhammad. It was a pivotal treaty between Muhammad, representing the state of Medina, and the Qurayshi tribe of Mecca in **January 628** (corresponding to **Dhu al-Qi'dah, AH 6**). It helped to decrease tension between the two cities, affirmed peace for a period of **10 years**, and authorised Muhammad's followers to return the following year **in a peaceful pilgrimage, later known as The First Pilgrimage.**

The treaty of Hdaybiah was a great victory for Islam. At first, the Muslims were disappointed. **especially Umar**, for unfavourable terms of the Treaty. In order to dispel the idea of the Muslims the following verse of the Quran was revealed to the Prophet: "**Verily we have given unto thee a clear victory.**" The terms of the treaty show the greatness of the Prophet and the superiority of the cause. Though the treaty seemed outwardly humiliating on the part of the Muslims, it gave Muhammad (PBUH) great advantages. **His political status as an independent power was acknowledged** by the treaty moreover, **the ten-year truce gave time and opportunity for Islam to expand and force its claims upon the conviction of the Quraysh**, while conquest-political and spiritual might be followed on every other side. As a result of this treaty, a great number of people joined the faith of Muhammad (PBUH).

Sayyiduna Imam Zuhri has said: When the ceasefire took effect and the peace was restored, the people started going to meet each other and the call to Islam began to spread. Anyone who had even a little bit of common sense entered the fold of Islam; **and within two years from the treaty of Hdaybiyah to the conquest of Makkah**, the number of people embracing Islam was equal to those who had embraced Islam before this period altogether, even more than that. Imam Zuhri, the biographer of Muhammad (Sm') also says, "There was no man of sense of judgment amongst the idolaters who was not led thereby to join Islam." Great warriors like **Khalid Bin Walid and Amr Ibn- Al As** embraced Islam after the treaty of Hdaybiah in this connection. Ibn Hisham says that at Hdaybiah the Prophet had **fourteen hundred followers** with him but two years later in the attack on Makkah he was followed by **ten thousand Muslim**. Also Once they felt secure from the side of Quraysh, muslims found the opportunity to defeat the opposing powers of northern and central Arabia. Only three months after the treaty the Jewish Centres **Khyber, Fidak, and Tabuk** were conquered and the allied tribes of Quraysh began to embrace Islam one after another.

The Treaty of Hudaibiyah aided in maintaining peace between the states of Makkah and Madinah. It ensured Muslims a chance to go on a peaceful pilgrimage to the holy Kaaba and allowed the formation of allies. For the true followers of Islam, it noted down and offered vital lessons on peace, patience, and victory.

4) What are the teachings of the Farewell sermon of the Prophet Muhammad (PBUH)?

--On the 9th of Zil-Hajj the Prophet left Makkah for Mina and passed the night there. After morning prayers, he rode the camel, Caswa and proceeded to Arafat in the company of his followers. Before completing all the rites of the pilgrimage, he addressed the assembled multitude from the top of the Jabal-Ul-Arafat. The speeches which he delivered on this occasion are still fresh in the memory of every Muslim. This sermon was historically significant for multiple reasons which include:

1. Brotherhood: Rasulullah's (PBUH) farewell speech not only binds all Muslims to a strong bond of brotherhood but also ensures all kinds of security, including the safety of life, dignity and property of all. Nothing remained to provide in the sermon those are relevant to the life and society of every modern state, either the Western or Eastern world. Holy Apostle (PBUH) provisioned as a final point of the essentials of human life- Declaration of Universal Human Rights, removing all kinds of racism, being trampled all ignorance of jahiliyyah, removing bloodshed and riba.

2. Human Rights: Although all basic needs and human rights were declared in the sermon regarded women, slaves, social security, orphan, life and property, offenders, inheritance, the practice of religion, dignity for each other, economic safety etc. were guaranteed in the life and society practically; the Apostle (PBUH) enkindled all present believers by re-expressing these rights in the last sermon of his life.

3. Faithfulness: The Holy Prophet (PBUH) reminded the present gathering that they must be accountable to Allah for what they have done in worldly life, and he emphasized everyone to follow perfectly the path shown by him. In the address, all believers were warned that no one could save them from going astray unless they adhered to the Qur'an and the Sunnah. So, the necessities and the historical importance of the sermon for ummah are undeniable, particularly because the sermon always urges believers to build a society based on justice free from exploitation and discrimination, irrespective of class, caste and religion.

4. Universality: Though the instructions of the sermon are basically directed to the believers, these are equally applicable for every country and nation in the world; because these principles can make any country or nation a peaceful and prosperous nation based on unity, equality and brotherhood. Thus farewell sermon is eternal and universal- given by the last Prophet -still calls on all humanity today to build peaceful law and order, social security, sustainable and justified human rights, a better life and a better society.

The address is not only incredible for its eloquence but also its glorious and sublime message to humankind on the earth. No better principles have been set in any other speech in the world than the Farewell sermon on ethics. Every sentence breathes a sense of greatness and establishes righteous and fair dealing among humanity on a workable basis. This sermon consolidates the unity of ummah, establishes all types of Muslims of the world into one brotherhood, It touches the end by determining a social system that is completely free from all forms of exploitation and injustice. In the context of knitting such artistic slides, it can be said the farewell sermon of Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) holds its position as the world's most incredible speech forever.

5) Explain the Evolution of Islamic Historiography mentioning the popular Classic Muslim Historians- Ibn Hisham, Ibn Qutaiba and Tabari.

-Same as Question 1.

6) Why Ibn Khaldun's Contributions as a Historian is praiseworthy? What do you know about 'Muqaddima ibn Khaldun'?

- Ibn Khaldun is considered one of the most important historians in the Islamic world, and his contributions to the field of historiography are praiseworthy for several reasons:

Emphasis on causality and social structures: Ibn Khaldun's work emphasized the role of causality and social structures in history, rather than simply listing events in chronological order. He believed that history was shaped by a variety of factors, including geography, climate, social organization, and economic conditions.

Development of the concept of 'Asabiyyah: Ibn Khaldun's most famous contribution to historiography is his development of the concept of 'asabiyyah, or social cohesion. He believed that the strength of society was directly related to the strength of its social cohesion and that societies tended to go through cycles of growth and decline as their social cohesion waxed and waned.

Importance of primary sources: Ibn Khaldun believed that historians should rely on primary sources and eyewitness accounts whenever possible, rather than relying on hearsay or secondary sources. He emphasized the importance of rigorous research and verification in historical writing.

Ibn Khaldun's most famous work is his "Muqaddimah" ("Introduction" in English), which is a comprehensive introduction to his philosophy of history. The "Muqaddimah" covers a wide range of topics, including the nature of history, the role of the historian, and the importance of social structures and group psychology in shaping historical events.

The "Muqaddimah" is also notable for its critique of previous historians and their methodologies, and for its detailed analysis of the rise and fall of various Islamic dynasties. The book's emphasis on causality and social structures influenced later historians and social scientists, and it remains an important work in the fields of history and sociology today.

7) Illustrate the Contribution of 'Baitul Hikmah' in Spreading Islamic History, Science and Culture.

- The House of Wisdom (Bayt Al-Hikmah) was seen as one of the leading libraries in Islamic history that appeared during the Golden age of Islam. It was initiated by the Abbasid dynasty. The House Of Wisdom had crucial role to play in linking the Islamic world fronts in east and west and in introducing the heritage in its perfect form to all Muslims in order to preserve it from loss and deterioration. As a result, the library gained great fame in the Islamic world for it was the first scientific and educational library that assembled scientists, scholars and translators to study and research. The house of wisdom had become an exemplary model for other Caliphs and princes who tried to simulate and find new libraries and houses of wisdom that can compete with the one in Baghdad, this contest had attained intellectual and scientific advancements in every sphere in the Islamic world. The libraries that have flourished following the example of the House of wisdom have had their doors open to scholars from all over the world. The house wisdom was a centre of knowledge and education, it was a rival of Constantinople's if it did not exceed it. It was the model for other libraries and similar institutions throughout the soil of Islamic civilization. The example of the house of wisdom was remarkably followed and its influence appeared when other many public libraries emerged all the way from Bokhara and Merv, in the heart of Asia, on the route to China through Basra and Damascus, Algiers and Cairo. The famous geographer Yaqut al Hamawi who had visited Merv in the late 1220s, found more than twelve libraries there opened for public. And the same as the house of wisdom in

Baghdad functioned, **ten libraries were through endowments (awqaf)**. He interestingly expressed his admiration for about the lending policies of the libraries there, he noted that libraries in Merv were being liberal enough to lend him more than **200 volumes** he could use in his room at the same time. Employees in the House of Wisdom in Baghdad were people of higher intellectual abilities, the same was emulated in every public library across the Muslim world. They often had a staff list that reach sometimes hundreds of copyists, illuminators, binders, translators, and authors. Those whom we can consider librarians were not randomly chosen but they usually were scholars, poets, multilingual and writers who on the other side were well paid by caliphs, rulers or nobles.

Many of the Islamic libraries included also not halls for reading and book storing, but they also they contained rooms for meetings and other rooms for discussions and debating that were help sometimes between different libraries and different scholars which implies the competition among libraries for scientific achievements, reputation and glory of the library itself. The Muslim libraries have played a major role in translating and transmitting works of **Greek, Persian, Indian and Assyrian** physicians and philosophers, works that later became the basic textbooks in **European schools of Bologna, Naples and Paris**. It is likely that without the Muslim libraries, modern Europe's scientific and intellectual progress would have been remarkably inhibited.

8)Identify the three Miracles of the Holy Quran according to Dr. Muhammad Abdullah Draz's book "Al Bina al-Azim".

According to **Dr Muhammad Abdullah Draz's** book **"Al Bina al-Azim"**, the three miracles of the Holy Quran are:

1)The linguistic miracle: The Quran's language is considered to be a miracle in itself, as it is considered to be the pinnacle of Arabic literary excellence. The Quran's style, eloquence, and literary devices are seen as proof of its divine origin.

2)The scientific miracle: The Quran contains several scientific facts that were unknown at the time of its revelation, but have since been proven true by modern science. For example, the Quran describes the stages of embryonic development in detail, and also contains accurate descriptions of the water cycle and the formation of the universe.

3)The Legal Miracle: The Quran provides guidance on all aspects of human life, including social, economic, and political issues. It contains principles of justice, fairness, and compassion, and promotes the well-being of individuals and society as a whole. The Quran's legal system is also characterized by its flexibility and adaptability to changing circumstances. It is a timeless and universal system that is relevant to all people, in all times and places.

9)We will show them our signs in horizons and within themselves until it becomes clear to them that is the truth" (41:53), Identify the 'signs in horizons and within themselves'?

The phrase **"signs in horizons and within themselves"** in Quranic verse **41:53** refers to the various signs and proofs of Allah's existence and power that can be observed in the natural world (horizons) and within ourselves (the human body and mind).

Some examples of signs in horizons include **the intricate design of the universe, the laws of physics and mathematics that govern it, and the diversity of life on Earth**. These signs point to the existence of a creator and sustainer who has created everything with a purpose.

Signs within ourselves refer to the complexity and design of the human body and mind. The Quran describes the human being as a "miracle of creation," with intricate systems and organs that work together to sustain life. The human mind and consciousness are also seen as signs of Allah's existence and power, as they allow us to think, reason, and reflect on the world around us.

Overall, the signs in horizons and within ourselves are meant to lead us to recognize and acknowledge the truth of Allah's existence and power, as stated in the Quranic verse: "until it becomes clear to them that is the truth." (41:53)

10) Mention any two of the Scientific Miracles in the Holy Quran.

- There are several scientific miracles in the Holy Quran, but here are two examples:

1) **The Big Bang Theory Miracle:** The big bang theory states that, initially, our universe was one primary **Nebula**. Then there was a Big Bang explosion and the earth came into existence. The Holy Quran has mentioned this fact in the Quran **1400 years ago**. Quran describes the big bang theory in the following words. "Do not the unbelievers see that the heavens and the earth were joined entity, and we separated them and made from water every living thing? Then will they not believe?" Surah Anbiya verse 30. It is clear from the verse of Holy Quran that the heavens and the Earth were one entity and Allah separated them.

2) **Creation of Everything from Water:** Modern science tells us that every living thing contains **60% to 70% of water** in its body. Our body consists of cells and cells contain water in them. But Allah has mentioned this fact hundreds of years back in the Holy Quran. There is a verse in the Holy Quran which tells us that: "And we have created every living thing from water" Surah Anbiya Verse 30. Science has proved this fact a few years ago but Allah has mentioned it in the Holy Quran more than 1400 hundred years ago.

11) What is the comprehensive and immortal Miracle of Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) as all the messengers are sent with miracles? Identify the salient features of Muhammad's (P.B.U.H) miracle.

- **The comprehensive and immortal miracle of Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) is the Holy Quran.** Unlike the miracles of other prophets, which were limited to a particular time and place, the Quran is a universal miracle that is meant to guide humanity until the end of time. The salient features of Prophet Muhammad's (PBUH) miracle, the Holy Quran, are:

Inimitability: The Quran is considered to be inimitable, meaning that no human can produce a work of literature that matches its beauty, eloquence, and depth of meaning. This is seen as proof of the Quran's divine origin, as it is believed that only God could have produced such a work.

Timelessness: The Quran's message is meant to be relevant to all people, in all times and places. The Quran contains guidance for all aspects of human life, from personal morality to social justice, and its teachings are meant to be applicable in all situations.

Consistency: The Quran is a consistent and coherent work, with a clear message that is free from contradictions. The Quran's teachings are internally consistent, and its message is consistent with the teachings of previous prophets.

Prophecy: The Quran contains several prophecies that have been fulfilled, including the conquest of Mecca and the spread of Islam. These prophecies are seen as evidence of the Quran's divine origin and its status as a guide for humanity.

Scientific Accuracy: The Quran contains descriptions of the universe, the natural world, and the human body that are consistent with modern scientific knowledge. These scientific insights are seen as proof of the Quran's divine origin, as they could not have been known to humans at the time of its revelation.

Overall, the Holy Quran is considered to be a comprehensive and immortal miracle that is meant to guide humanity until the end of time. Its inimitability, timelessness, consistency, prophecy, and scientific accuracy are all seen as evidence of its divine origin and its status as a guidance for humanity.

12) 'Jabir Ibn Haiyan is the father of modern chemistry', explain.

-Jabir Ibn Hayyan was a Muslim chemist, alchemist, and philosopher who lived during the Islamic Golden Age in the 8th century. He is often referred to as the "father of modern chemistry" because of his pioneering work in the field of chemistry and his development of the scientific method.

Jabir Ibn Hayyan was one of the first scientists to apply the principles of experimentation and empirical observation to the study of chemistry. He conducted a series of experiments on various chemical compounds and documented his findings in his works, including "The Book of the Composition of Alchemy" and "The Book of the Balances".

One of Jabir Ibn Hayyan's most significant contributions to modern chemistry was his development of the concept of scientific classification of substances. He classified substances into three categories: spirits, metals, and compounds, and he introduced the concept of oxidation and reduction in chemical reactions. He also discovered several new chemical compounds, including hydrochloric acid, nitric acid, and sulfuric acid.

Jabir Ibn Hayyan's work in chemistry was widely influential in the Islamic world and Europe, and his writings were translated into Latin and other European languages during the Middle Ages. His methods and approaches to chemistry paved the way for the development of modern chemistry, and he is considered a founding figure in the field of chemistry.

Overall, Jabir Ibn Hayyan's work in chemistry was ground-breaking and helped to establish the foundations of modern chemistry. His approach to experimentation and his emphasis on empirical observation and documentation set the stage for the development of modern scientific methods and the scientific revolution that followed.

13) Evaluate 'Ibn Khaldun' as a Historian according to 'De boer' and Walter J. Fischel's Observations.

- Ibn Khaldun was an Arab sociologist, philosopher, and historian widely acknowledged to be one of the greatest social scientists of the Middle Ages. De Boer says "Ibn Khaldun is the first who tried to explain fully the evolution and progress of society, its causes and factors, and their effects on the formation of man's mind and sentiment as well as the formation of society."

Ibn Khaldun is trying to present a sociological theory through his book Al Muqaddimah where he is concerned with widespread strong collective belief and faith that would enable to understand a society among the Bedouins of the Arab, who used to spend the majority of their time in the desert. Blood relationships and purity of lineage were some of the key characteristics of the Bedouins, due to which, there was an increased sense of solidarity among the members. The fundamental characteristic of his theory is the concept of "Al-asabiyyah" or group feeling. Although it was a

familiar term in the pre-Islamic era, it was Ibn Khaldun's Muqaddimah which made it popular, where it is described as a fundamental bond of humankind.

"Ibn Khaldun", De Boer observes. "Comes forward with a claim to establish the new philosophical discipline of which Aristotle had no conception". The historical works of his forerunners, particularly of Tabari and Masudi, have had the most influence on the development of his thoughts. According to Walter J. Fischel the historian Tabari is regarded by Ibn Khaldun as one of the few good historians, and counted among those historians of whom there are "not more than the fingers on one hand". Walter J. Fischel was a Jewish historian who specialized in the history of medieval Islam. In his work, Fischel described Ibn Khaldun as a highly original and creative historian who had a profound influence on the development of Islamic historiography.

According to Fischel, Ibn Khaldun's most important contribution to the field was his innovative method of historical analysis, which was based on a systematic study of the causes of political and social change. He also praised Ibn Khaldun's philosophical insights and his ability to draw connections between events and phenomena in a way that was both comprehensive and insightful. Ibn Khaldun leans heavily on Tabari's historical works and draws material from him for his history of the non-Arabic peoples and for the illustration of his own socio-philosophical views. Masudi discarded the old school of historiography which followed closely on the traditionist method and conceived of a new style and technique of history writing which took cognizance of society and social aspects of human life. This particular standpoint was fully developed by Ibn Khaldun and he made a scientific and analytic study of history, which established history as a science a subject which teaches us that it is not a mere catalogue of facts, nor a mere narrative of past happenings, but a science to be studied for understanding the causes of the rise and fall of States and nations. It is Ibn Khaldun's Maqaddima (prolegomena) which forms his social and political philosophy.

Overall, both De Boer and Walter J. Fischel held Ibn Khaldun in high regard as a historian and philosopher and praised him for his innovative approach to historical writing and his insightful observations about the nature of political and social change. Their assessments of Ibn Khaldun continue to be widely accepted among historians and scholars, and his works remain an important source of knowledge and insight into the history and culture of the Islamic world.

14) Evaluate Ibn Sina's 'Canon of Medicine' as a Medical Bible.

- Ibn Sina's "Canon of Medicine" is a medical textbook that was written in the 11th century and was used as a standard medical reference in Europe for over 500 years. The book is divided into five volumes and covers a wide range of medical topics, including anatomy, physiology, pathology, and pharmacology.

In terms of its historical significance, the "Canon of Medicine" was a groundbreaking work that synthesized the medical knowledge of the ancient Greeks, Persians, and Arabs, and helped to establish the foundation for modern medicine. The book's systematic approach to medical diagnosis and treatment was based on the principles of empirical observation and experimentation.

He also stressed the importance of prevention. Discussing diet and the influence of climate and environmental factors on health, the book also discusses rabies, hydrocele, breast cancer, tumor, labor, and treatments for poisons. Other conditions he described include chronic nephritis, facial paralyses, ulcer of the stomach, and types of hepatitis and their causes. He discussed in great length the dilation and contraction of the pupils and how they were used in diagnosis, as well as the six motor muscles of the eye and the function of the tear ducts. Noting the contagious nature of some

diseases, he attributed this to "traces" left in the air by the sick person helped to establish the science.

In addition to a description of 740 medicinal plants and drugs made from them, he laid out a series of basic rules for clinical drug trials, many of which continue to serve as the basis of modern clinical trials scientific basis for modern medicine. Ibn Sina and his Canon of Medicine has become so important that no discussion on the history of medicine can be complete without referring to him. He has earned many honorary titles, notably the "Galen of Islam." His preeminence in the Latin West was even enshrined by Dante (1265-1321), the fourteenth-century Italian poet, who ranked Ibn Sina between Hippocrates and Galen.

15) Evaluate the Significance of Madina Charter according to the great historian William Muir's Book- "A Life of Mahomet and History of Islam to the Era of the Hegira".

-The importance of the charter lies in the fact that it may be regarded as the First Written Constitution in the annals of the world. Before the Prophet of Islam, many rulers ruled but none gave such a Written Constitution to his people. The Charter may also be called the Magna Charta of early Islam. It announced the great principles of civic equality, freedom of worship and religious tolerance. It was Muhammad (Sm.) who, for the first time, realised the importance of the people's co-operation and goodwill in the administration of the country. The Charter proves that Muhammad (Sm.) was not only a religious preacher, but also one of the greatest statesmen the world has ever produced. The provisions of this Charter show that he not only strengthened his hands against the Quraysh but also established his paramount position in the city of Madinah.

In this connection, William Muir, a 19th-century British historian, says, "It reveals the Man in his real greatness-a master-mind, not only of his own but of all ages. Muir considered the Madina Charter a significant event in the history of Islam. In his book, "A Life of Mahomet and History of Islam to the Era of the Hegira", Muir described the Madina Charter as a landmark agreement between the Muslims and the Jews of Madina that established the foundations of a pluralistic society.

Muir praised the Madina Charter for its tolerant and inclusive provisions, which allowed for religious freedom and equal rights for all residents of the city, regardless of their religion. He believed that this document was a critical factor in the success of the early Islamic community in Madina and helped to establish a sense of unity and cooperation among the diverse groups of people who lived there.

In addition, Muir viewed the Madina Charter as a precursor to modern concepts of political and religious freedom, and as a demonstration of the progressive and enlightened values of early Islam. He considered it to be a testament to the wisdom and foresight of the Prophet Muhammad, who recognized the importance of creating a society that was based on mutual respect and tolerance.

Overall, Muir considered the Madina Charter to be a key moment in the history of Islam, and saw it as having a lasting impact on the development of Muslim society and culture. According to Muir, the Madina Charter helped to lay the foundations for the growth and success of the early Islamic state, and its principles continue to influence Islamic thought and practice to this day.

16) Recognize the Muhammad Ibn Musa al-Khwarizmi as the father of algebra.

- Algebra refers to the study of equations and their solutions. Algebra is used to solve problems involving variables, such as finding the value of an unknown quantity or predicting the outcome of a particular event.

Muhammad ibn Musa al-Khwarizmi is widely known as the Father of Algebra. He was an influential mathematician and astronomer who lived in the 9th century in what is now modern-day Iraq. Al-Khwarizmi is credited with developing the mathematical discipline of algebra and introducing it to the Western world through his influential works.

Al-Khwarizmi's contributions to the field of algebra were significant, as he developed new methods for solving equations and introduced the concept of variables and constants.

One of al-Khwarizmi's most important works was his book, "Kitab al-Jabr wa'l-Muqabilah," which was translated into Latin as "The Book of Restoring and Balancing." This book introduced the concept of algebra to the Western world and became a widely studied text in medieval Europe. It contained a number of algebraic problems and their solutions, which helped to spread the ideas of algebra throughout the world.

In his book, al-Khwarizmi also introduced the concept of variables and constants, which are essential to modern algebra. Al-Khwarizmi's use of variables and constants allowed for a more flexible and general approach to solving equations.

Another significant contribution of al-Khwarizmi was his development of the method of solving equations known as "al-jabr." Al-Khwarizmi's method of al-jabr was widely used and became the basis for modern algebraic techniques.

17) Why Al-Biruni is considered as one of the greatest scientist of Muslim civilization.

- George Sarton, the founder of the History of Science discipline, defined al-Biruni as "one of the very greatest scientists of Islam, and, all considered, one of the greatest of all times". A universal genius that lived in the Central Asia a thousand of years ago, al-Biruni "was so far ahead of his time that his most brilliant discoveries seemed incomprehensible to most of the scholars of his days", so wrote Bobojan Gafurov.

Al-Biruni was an astronomer, mathematician and philosopher, who studying physics and natural sciences too. His scientific body of work addresses almost all the sciences. He had excellent knowledge of ancient Greek and studied several works by ancient Greek scientists in their original forms; among them, there were Aristotle's Physics, Metaphysics, De Caelo, and Meteorology, the works of Euclid and Archimedes, the Almagest of the mathematician and astronomer Ptolemy. "When religious fanaticism swept medieval Europe, al-Biruni, as a forerunner of the Renaissance, was far in advance of the scientific thought then obtaining in Europe", writes one commentator. His contributions to modern science include:

Accurate measurements of the earth's circumference: Al-Biruni developed a method for accurately measuring the earth's circumference, which he calculated to be 40,248 km. His method involved measuring the height of a mountain and the angle of elevation of a star at the top and bottom of the mountain.

First recorded observation of the transit of Venus: In 1032 CE, Al-Biruni recorded the first observation of the transit of Venus across the sun. This observation provided important data for modern astronomers studying the movements of celestial bodies.

Pioneering work in geodesy: Al-Biruni's work in **geodesy**, the science of measuring the earth's shape and size, was groundbreaking. He developed a method for **determining the radius of the earth that was accurate to within 1%**, and also made significant contributions to the **study of the obliquity of the ecliptic and the precession of the equinoxes**.

Contributions to Astronomy: Al-Biruni made important contributions to the field of astronomy, including the development of an **accurate lunar calendar** and his work on determining the **direction of Mecca from any point on Earth**.

Studies of Hinduism and Indian culture: Al-Biruni's studies of Hinduism and Indian culture were groundbreaking and remain important sources of information today. He studied **Sanskrit texts** and wrote about the religion, culture, and history of India, and his work influenced later European scholars and philosophers.

Work in pharmacology and medicine: Al-Biruni was also a pioneering figure in the field of **pharmacology and medicine**. He wrote extensively on the properties of **plants and minerals** used in medicine and was one of the first to suggest that **diseases could be transmitted through water and soil**.

These are just a few of the reasons why Al-Biruni is considered one of the greatest scientists of the Muslim civilization. His contributions to science, mathematics, and culture continue to inspire and influence scholars and researchers around the world today.

18) Describe five Muslim inventions that changed the modern world.

Muslim scholars and inventors made numerous contributions to science, technology, and culture that continue to influence the modern world. Here are five Muslim inventions that have had a significant impact on the world:

1) Algebra: The Persian mathematician **Al-Khwarizmi** is considered the father of algebra, having introduced the concept of using letters to represent numbers and developing the rules for solving equations. This invention has had a significant impact on modern mathematics and science, including engineering, physics, and computer science.

2) Optics: The Arab physicist and mathematician **Ibn al-Haytham**, also known as **Alhazen**, made significant contributions to the field of optics. He developed the first accurate explanation of vision, which was based on the concept of light rays entering the eye. His work also led to the invention of the camera obscura, a precursor to the modern camera.

3) Surgical instruments: The Muslim physician **Al-Zahrawi**, also known as **Albucasis**, made important contributions to the field of surgery. He invented many surgical instruments that are still used today, including **forceps, scalpels, and surgical scissors**. He also wrote a comprehensive medical encyclopedia that included descriptions of surgical procedures and treatments.

4) Water clock: The Arab engineer and mathematician **Al-Jazari** invented the **first mechanical water clock in the 12th century**. This invention allowed for accurate timekeeping and was used in Islamic religious observances, as well as in secular settings such as astronomical observations and navigation.

5) Flying machine: The Muslim polymath **Abbas Ibn Firnas** is credited with developing the first flying machine in the **9th century**. He created a rudimentary glider that he used to fly a short distance before landing safely. While his invention did not lead to the development of modern aviation, it was

an important precursor to the study of aerodynamics and the development of aircraft. These are just a few examples of the many Muslim inventions that have had a lasting impact on the modern world.

19) Illustrate the Significance of Science and Culture in Islam.

Islam is a religion that emphasizes the importance of seeking knowledge and understanding the world around us. As such, science has played a critical role in Islamic history and culture. From mathematics and astronomy to medicine and chemistry, Muslim scientists have made significant contributions to the advancement of human knowledge and understanding.

At the heart of the relationship between Islam and science is the idea that the pursuit of knowledge is a religious duty. The Qur'an, Islam's holy book, encourages Muslims to explore the natural world and seek knowledge from it. In fact, the first word revealed to Prophet Muhammad in the Qur'an was "Read" (96:1), emphasizing the importance of education and learning.

One of the most important contributions of Muslim scientists to the world of science was the development of the scientific method. Muslim scholars such as Alhazen and Ibn Rushd helped to establish the principles of scientific inquiry that we still use today. They emphasized the importance of observation, experimentation, and empirical evidence in understanding the natural world.

Muslim scientists also made significant contributions to fields such as mathematics, astronomy, and medicine. Al-Khwarizmi for example, is often referred to as the "father of algebra" for his work in developing the algebraic system we use today. Other notable Muslim scientists include Ibn al-Haytham who made significant contributions to the fields of optics and visual perception, and Ibn Sina who is known for his work in medicine and philosophy.

Islam has a long and rich tradition of scientific inquiry, which has been integrated into Islamic philosophy and culture. Muslim scholars made significant contributions to fields such as mathematics, astronomy, medicine, and chemistry, which have had a lasting impact on the world. The Quran also emphasizes the importance of observation and reason, encouraging Muslims to explore the natural world and to seek knowledge through scientific inquiry.

Islam has been a major force for cultural exchange and dialogue throughout history. Muslim scholars and traders travelled extensively, bringing with them knowledge, ideas, and cultural practices from different parts of the world. This exchange of culture and ideas helped to foster intellectual and artistic development and contributed to the richness and diversity of Islamic culture.

Islamic art and architecture are renowned for their beauty, intricacy, and spiritual significance. Islamic artists and architects have created stunning works of art, such as calligraphy, mosaics, and ceramics, which are still admired and studied today. Islamic architecture, with its emphasis on geometric patterns, domes, and arches, has also had a profound influence on the development of architecture around the world.

Education has been highly valued in Islamic culture, and Islamic scholars have made significant contributions to the development of educational systems and institutions. The establishment of schools, libraries, and universities has played a crucial role in the preservation and dissemination of knowledge and culture.

In summary, science and culture have been integral to the development of Islam throughout history. The Islamic tradition has emphasized the importance of scientific inquiry, cultural exchange, and artistic expression, which have contributed to the richness and diversity of Islamic culture and to the advancement of human knowledge and understanding.

20) Describe three Influential Muslim Scientists with their major Inventions.

Al-Khwarizmi: Al-Khwarizmi was a Muslim mathematician and astronomer who lived during the Islamic Golden Age. He is considered the father of algebra and made significant contributions to the fields of mathematics and astronomy. His major inventions include the development of algebraic symbols and the concept of the algorithm, which is a set of instructions for solving a problem.

Ibn al-Haytham: Ibn al-Haytham was a Muslim scientist who made significant contributions to the fields of optics and physics. He is considered the father of modern optics and wrote several influential books on the subject, including "Kitab al-Manazir," which described the properties of light and the nature of vision. His major invention was the development of the scientific method, which is a systematic approach to scientific inquiry.

Ibn Sina: Also known as Avicenna, Ibn Sina was a Muslim polymath who made significant contributions to several fields, including medicine and philosophy. He wrote several influential books, including "The Canon of Medicine," which was used as a medical textbook in Europe for over 500 years. His major inventions include the development of a system of medicine based on the principles of Greek medicine, and the use of experimental medicine to test treatments and remedies.

21) Mention Five Muslim Scientists Described as Father or Founder of a Field.

Jabir ibn Hayyan: Also known as Geber, Jabir ibn Hayyan is considered the father of chemistry. He lived during the Islamic Golden Age and made significant contributions to the field of chemistry, including discovering several chemical processes, such as distillation and crystallization.

Al-Khwarizmi: Known as the father of algebra, Al-Khwarizmi was a Muslim mathematician who lived during the Islamic Golden Age. He wrote several influential books on mathematics, including "Al-Jabr wa al-Muqabalah," which introduced the concept of algebra.

Ibn al-Haytham: Also known as Alhazen, Ibn al-Haytham was a Muslim scientist who made significant contributions to the fields of optics and physics. He is considered the father of modern optics and wrote several influential books on the subject, including "Kitab al-Manazir," which described the properties of light and the nature of vision.

Al-Biruni: The founder of Indology, father of comparative religion and geodesy, and the first anthropologist titles for his remarkable description of early 11th-century India. Georg Morgenstierne regarded him as the founder of comparative studies in human culture. Al-Biruni is also known as the father of Islamic pharmacy.

Ibn Sina: Widely regarded as the father of early modern medicine as well as the father of clinical pharmacology. Also known as Avicenna, Ibn Sina was a Muslim polymath who made significant contributions to several fields, including medicine and philosophy. He wrote several influential books, including "The Canon of Medicine," which was used as a medical textbook in Europe for over 500 years.

22) What are the types of Beliefs in God?

-Theism: Theism is believing in the existence of God or believing in the existence of one or more divinities or deities. Islam, Christianity, Hinduism, Judaism, Sikhism, and Zoroastrianism are all theistic religions.

Monotheism: The majority of the world has the view that only one God exists. The **Abrahamic faiths - Judaism, Christianity and Islam** -, as well as **Plato's concept of God**, all affirm monotheism. Jews, Christians and Muslims all agree that God is an eternally existent being that exists apart from space and time, who is the creator of the universe, and is omnipotent (all-powerful), omniscient (all-knowing), omnibenevolent (all-loving) and omnipresent (all-present).

Pantheism: The belief that **God is equivalent to Nature or the physical universe**, or that everything is of an all-encompassing immanent abstract God is a widely common phenomenon even in monotheistic religions. Almost in all major religions, many adherents believe in pantheism. The concept has been discussed as far back as the time of the philosophers of Ancient Greece, including **Thales, Parmenides and Heraclitus**, also in modern ages **Baruch Spinoza**.

Deism: It is a form of monotheism in which it is believed that one God exists, but that this God does not intervene in the world, or interfere with human life and the laws of the universe. **It posits a non-interventionist creator who permits the universe to run itself according to natural laws**.

Polytheism: As an anthropomorphic attribute, polytheism is the belief in or worship of multiple gods. These gods are often seen as similar to humans in their personality traits but with additional individual powers, abilities, knowledge or perceptions. **Hard Polytheism** views the gods as being distinct and separate beings, such as in **Ancient Greek Mythology**. **Soft Polytheism** views the gods as being subsumed into a greater whole, as in **most forms of Hinduism**.

23) What are the Branches of Islamic knowledge in your Eye?

Islamic knowledge encompasses a wide range of subjects related to the religion of Islam, its teachings, and its practices. Some of the traditional branches of Islamic knowledge include:

Quranic studies: This branch of Islamic knowledge focuses on the study of the Quran, its interpretation, and its application in everyday life.

Hadith studies: This branch of Islamic knowledge focuses on the study of the Prophet Muhammad's sayings, actions, and teachings.

Fiqh (Islamic jurisprudence): This branch of Islamic knowledge deals with the study of Islamic law, including its principles, sources, and application in various areas of life, such as worship, family, business, and politics.

Aqeedah (Islamic theology): This branch of Islamic knowledge deals with the study of Islamic beliefs, including the existence of Allah, the Prophets, and the Hereafter.

Tafsir (Quranic exegesis): This branch of Islamic knowledge focuses on the study of the Quranic commentary, including its language, style, and meaning.

Sufism (Islamic mysticism): This branch of Islamic knowledge deals with the study of Islamic spirituality, including practices such as meditation, remembrance of Allah, and detachment from worldly pleasures.

Arabic language: This branch of Islamic knowledge focuses on the study of the Arabic language, including its grammar, syntax, and vocabulary, which are essential for understanding the Quran and other Islamic texts.

There are also other branches of Islamic knowledge, such as Islamic history, Islamic economics, and Islamic art and architecture that are related to different aspects of Islamic civilization and culture.

24) Describe Major religions with basic concepts and their tenets.

- There are several major religions in the world, each with their own set of beliefs, practices, and tenets. Here are brief descriptions of some of the major religions and their basic concepts and tenets:

Christianity: Christianity is a monotheistic religion based on the life and teachings of Jesus Christ. Christians believe in one God who created the universe and sent his son, Jesus Christ, to redeem humanity from sin. The central tenet of Christianity is that Jesus Christ died on the cross and rose again, thus offering salvation to all who believe in him. Christians also believe in the Holy Trinity, consisting of **God the Father, Jesus Christ the Son, and the Holy Spirit.**

Islam: Islam is a monotheistic religion based on the teachings of the Prophet Muhammad, as recorded in the Quran. Muslims believe in one God, Allah, who created the universe and revealed his message to humanity through prophets such as Adam, Noah, Abraham, Moses, Jesus, and Muhammad. The central tenet of Islam is the belief in the oneness of God, known as Tawheed, and the acceptance of Muhammad as the final prophet. Muslims also follow the Five Pillars of Islam, which include the declaration of faith, prayer, fasting, charity, and pilgrimage to Mecca.

Judaism: Judaism is a monotheistic religion based on the belief in one God, who revealed his laws and commandments to the Jewish people through the prophets, as recorded in the **Hebrew Bible.** The central tenet of Judaism is the belief in the **covenant** between God and the Jewish people, and the importance of following the commandments and laws set forth in the Torah. **Jews also believe in the coming of a messiah, who will bring about the redemption of the world.**

Hinduism: Hinduism is a polytheistic religion that originated in India and has a diverse set of beliefs and practices. Hindus believe in **one ultimate reality, known as Brahman**, which can manifest itself in many different forms, including gods and goddesses. The central tenet of Hinduism is the belief in **karma**, which is the idea that one's actions in this life will determine one's destiny in the next. Hindus also believe in the cycle of birth, death, and **rebirth, known as samsara**, and the ultimate goal of achieving **moksha, or liberation from this cycle.**

Buddhism: Buddhism is a non-theistic religion based on the teachings of the **Buddha**, who taught that **suffering is caused by craving and attachment**, and that the **path to liberation is through the Eightfold Path.** Buddhists believe in the **Four Noble Truths**, which state that suffering exists, suffering is caused by craving, suffering can be ended, and the way to end suffering is through the Eightfold Path. Buddhists also believe in the concept of **impermanence**, that all things are constantly changing and nothing is permanent.

These are just brief descriptions of some of the major religions and their tenets. It's important to note that within each religion there are different sects, denominations, and interpretations of these beliefs and practices.

25) Illustrate a Comparative discussion among Islam, Christianity, Judaism, Hinduism and Buddhism with major features.

-Islam, Christianity, Judaism, Hinduism, and Buddhism are major religions with unique beliefs, practices, and cultural traditions. Here is a comparison of some of their major features:

1) Monotheism/Polytheism: Islam, Christianity, and Judaism are monotheistic religions, which means they believe in one God. Hinduism is a polytheistic religion that believes in multiple gods and goddesses. Buddhism is a non-theistic religion that does not believe in a single divine entity.

2) Sacred Texts: Islam has the Quran, Christianity has the Bible, Judaism has the Torah, Hinduism has the Vedas, and Buddhism has the Tripitaka. These texts are considered holy and contain the teachings, stories, and beliefs of each religion.

3) Prophets/Messengers: Islam recognizes **Prophet Muhammad** as the last prophet and messenger of God, while Christianity recognizes **Jesus Christ** as the son of God and the saviour of humanity. Judaism recognizes **Moses** as the greatest prophet, while Hinduism has many avatars or divine incarnations, such as **Lord Rama and Lord Krishna**. Buddhism does not have a concept of a divine messenger or prophet.

4) Salvation/Liberation: Islam, Christianity, and Judaism all believe in the concept of salvation, which is the idea of being saved from sin and granted eternal life in paradise. Hinduism believes in the concept of liberation or moksha, which is the ultimate goal of freeing oneself from the cycle of birth, death, and rebirth. Buddhism also believes in liberation from suffering, which is achieved through the Eightfold Path and the concept of enlightenment.

5) Rituals/Worship: Islam, Christianity, and Judaism have regular prayer and worship services in **mosques, churches, and synagogues**. Hinduism has a wide range of rituals and ceremonies, including puja (worship of deities), fire sacrifices, and meditation. Buddhism has meditation and mindfulness practices, but no set rituals or formal worship.

6) Ethics and Morality: Each religion has its own ethical and moral principles. Islam emphasizes the importance of justice, compassion, and kindness towards others. Christianity stresses love, forgiveness, and humility. Judaism emphasizes justice, compassion, and the importance of following God's commandments. Hinduism emphasizes the concept of dharma, which includes moral and ethical duties towards oneself, others, and the universe. Buddhism emphasizes the importance of compassion, non-violence, and the Eightfold Path.

26) Write short notes on the following:

1) Victory over Mecca: The victory over Mecca refers to the conquest of the city of Mecca by Muslim forces under the leadership of Prophet Muhammad in **630 CE**.

Prior to the conquest, Mecca was controlled by the pagan Quraysh tribe, which had been hostile towards the Muslim community and had even expelled them from the city. In 630 CE, Prophet Muhammad and his followers marched on Mecca with an army of 10,000 soldiers. The Quraysh did not put up much resistance, and Mecca was peacefully conquered by the Muslims.

The conquest of Mecca marked the end of the hostilities between the Muslims and the Quraysh, and cemented the position of **Islam as the dominant religion** in Arabia. It also opened up Mecca as a site of pilgrimage for Muslims, which has continued to this day as the annual Hajj pilgrimage. The victory over Mecca was seen as a triumph of the faith and helped to spread the message of Islam throughout Arabia and beyond.

II. The Farewell Pilgrimage - The Last Sermon of Prophet P.B.U.H. : The Farewell Pilgrimage was the last pilgrimage made by Prophet Muhammad to Mecca in **632 CE**, just a few months before his death. It is considered one of the most significant events in the history of Islam. During the Farewell Pilgrimage, Prophet Muhammad delivered his final sermon, known as the "Last Sermon" or

"Khutbah" in Arabic. The sermon covered a range of topics, including the importance of unity among Muslims, the equality of all human beings regardless of race or ethnicity, and the need for social justice and compassion. When Muhammad announced this intent, approximately 100,000 of his Sahaba gathered in Medina to perform the annual pilgrimage with him. Muhammad performed Hajj al-Qiran. Hajj al-Qirān is a type of Hajj in which Umrah and Hajj are performed together.

III. Bimaristan: Bimaristan is an Arabic term that refers to a hospital or medical center in the Islamic world. The term comes from the Persian word "bimar," which means sick or ill, and "stan," which means place or land.

During the Islamic Golden Age, Muslim physicians and scholars made significant contributions to the fields of medicine and healthcare. The bimaristan provided medical care to both Muslims and non-Muslims regardless of their social or economic status.

Bimaristans were typically large and well-equipped, with separate wards for men and women, as well as specialized wards for patients with specific diseases or conditions. They were staffed by skilled physicians and nurses, connected to medical schools where students could learn from experienced practitioners.

Bimaristans were also centres of learning and research, with physicians and scholars working together to develop new treatments and cures for various illnesses. They played an important role in the development of Islamic medicine and helped to advance the understanding of health and disease in the Islamic world and beyond.